



Q1) Inscriptions and literature of ancient India throw light on the socio-economic and political status of women of the time. Elucidate. (10 Marks, 150 Words)

प्राचीन भारत के शिलालेख और साहित्य तत्कालीन स्त्रियों की सामाजिक-आर्थिक और राजनीतिक स्थिति पर प्रकाश डालते हैं। स्पष्ट करें। (10 अंक, 150 शब्द)

Inscriptions and literature are a rich source of studying history including that of the various sections of society.

women were considered to be treated differently as history evolved in different regions as was visible through literature & inscriptions.

Literature

1. Vedic Literature

- It suggests the presence of women in & Vidhata & Ganas in Early Vedic period showcasing political presence.
- In later Vedic period, this changed with condition of women being secondary to that of man.

2. Sangam Literature

- It showcased the good socio-economic conditions of women in Tamilakam.

3. Bhakti Literature

It was also written by women many times showcasing gender equality is the Bhakti movement. eg. Andal, Lal Ded, Akkamahadevi

4. Literature about Rulers

Women ruler Rani Mangamal of Pandya kingdom can be seen in work of Kalidasa.

Inscriptions

1. The Satavahana period saw women even writing inscriptions eg. Nannaiyana Inscription

2. The Gran inscriptions showcased the practise of Sati which raises concerns about the conditions of women.

Thus, history can be viewed through a gendered lens by studying ancient inscriptions & literature

Feedback (For OFFICE use only)

Structure		Content	
Question Interpretation		Total :	